
Memorandum

THE ARLINGTON INSTITUTE

To: Steve Greer
From: [REDACTED]
Date: 25 January 1994
Subject: Strategy Meeting

Steve, if I heard you correctly, you said that two members of the strategy committee were called and encouraged not to attend the meeting. It seems to me that there are only three ways that that information would be available to someone outside of your organization: your phones are tapped, someone on the strategy committee is more than they have represented they are, or in other conversations you or [REDACTED] have communicated to someone outside of the committee who is on the committee and when and where the meeting will take place.

The problem with [REDACTED] the historical information you have told me, about how others have attempted to co-op CSETI, and some of the historical examples of similar activity that are in *Above Top Secret*, make it not at all far fetched to believe that among other things, someone on the committee is reporting on your activities. It is a reasonable concern.

If just money was at stake here -- say a corporate strategy about a new product launch -- extraordinary security precautions would be in place that would clearly identify what could not be communicated, and who one could talk to about what. Any leaks would provide great leverage to the competition and threaten the life of the company and the jobs of the individuals involved.

In this case, we have the most important project in human history (as we know it) complete with a very experienced and sophisticated opponent who has unusual capabilities and is intent upon making sure that you do not succeed. Until we are able to put other pieces of the puzzle in place, the most valuable ammunition that the opponents have is information on what CSETI is doing and planning to do. And they can only get that from you.

You should assume that every conversation you have on any of your phones is being listened to. Picture it in your mind: someone seated at a computer console with a set of earphones and the ability at a moment's notice to switch to any other phone number he or she wants at a moment's notice. Think of it every time you pick up the phone. When you are in a hotel, the second you have called your office, every other conversation from your room phone could well be monitored. They can follow you around the world.

Consider that every fax that you send is being read by someone in the FBI who is collecting information for only one purpose: to assure that you fail -- something that cannot be allowed to happen.

With those things in mind, consider that, like Luke Skywalker flying against the death star, there are a small number of things associated with our plans that, if destroyed, could in turn destroy the whole operation. These key pieces of information must be protected and controlled at all cost. Very few people must know about them.

Additionally, we must guard against communicating things that cause the opposition to feel threatened. If they do, they will not hesitate to strike out to preempt.

So, we must:

- Assume we are penetrated, and therefore always on guard about what is said and otherwise communicated
- Identify and protect our most valuable information from disclosure
- Give no suggestion of threat to the opposition

What must we protect?

1. We must protect the knowledge about how sophisticated we might be. We must give the appearance of not being threatening. Our sources and contacts must not be known. Not even alluded to, in most cases. There is no reason to tell other researchers who have pending FOIA requests that, "We have contact with a very high government official . . ." For the bad guys, that puts up a red flag -- we threaten them -- and it is not at all necessary for accomplishing what is needed. Simply saying that we have a new source that thinks that he can get FOIA requests out of the government is quite adequate. We must take David Gergen's name out of the material. We must all fight against the natural desire to impress others with who we are talking to and how sophisticated we are in terms of the execution of Project Starlight.
2. We must resolutely protect those key pieces of information that have the potential of undoing the whole operation. That includes, at least, the identity of the government witnesses, any meetings with high-level government officials (in the U.S. and abroad), original BAE photos and videos, names of benefactors. Never leave sensitive materials in hotel rooms or any other place. [In the government, there are briefcases with a handcuff on them, to assure that the carrier never lets them out of his or her sight.]
3. We must compartmentalize the information. Unless there is a particular need to do so, we should not list the names of all of the key players on any one document. Strategy people should be kept separate from briefing folks, and advisory board, etc. That way no one gets the whole picture easily.
4. We must use the strategy committee as a resource group -- to generate ideas, etc. -- but not to actually build the strategy. They should not carry away any complete plans or a detailed outline of what will actually happen to who, when. They should not, for instance know about The Eddie Mahe Company, by name. We can talk about a consulting firm that might help us, but not more.
5. We must not write about activities that would cause specific apprehension by the opposition. Instead of putting something about a building a strategy for dealing with a black command and control organization in the agenda for the strategy meeting, just say, "Anticipating problems," or something like that. We must then be careful what we say about all that in the meeting. The group should be used to solicit ideas, but not to build the plan.

This project is of extraordinary importance, and as Eddie and Ladonna say in the attached memo, it may all hinge on the credibility of CSETI. In any case, we must begin to start to act like it will and put in place a new framework for dealing with each other and those outside of the organization.